LUIS HENRIQUE RIBEIRO LINHARES

270 Bay State Road
Boston MA 02215 USA
Cell: (857) 264-7958
Email: lhrlinha@bu.edu
Website: https://www.luislinhares.com

EDUCATION

Ph.D., Economics, Boston University, Boston MA, May 2027 (expected)
M.Sc., Economics, São Paulo School of Economics, São Paulo, Brazil, 2021
M.A., Economics, São Paulo School of Economics, São Paulo, Brazil, 2018
B.E., Industrial Engineering, University of São Paulo, São Paulo, Brazil, 2013

FIELDS OF INTEREST

Microeconomic Theory, Industrial Organization, Behavioral Economics and Decision Theory

WORKING PAPERS

"Strategic Obfuscation: Influence Through Information Costs," (with Daniel Monte) Job Market Paper. September 2026

WORK IN PROGRESS

"An Axiomatic Approach to Conformity,"
"Uncertain Prices and Competition: Who Absorbs the Risk?"

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

INSTRUCTOR OF RECORD

Sophomore Tutorial, Department of Economics, Harvard University, Fall 2026
Instructor of Record, PhD Math Camp, Department of Economics, Boston University, Summer 2025
Instructor of Record, Market Structure and Economic Performance, Department of Economics, Boston University, Summer 2024

TEACHING FELLOW

Introduction to Mathematical and Computational Economics (Graduate), Department of Economics, Boston University, Fall 2025
Micro Theory (Graduate), Department of Economics, Boston University, Spring 2023
Introduction to Microeconomics, Department of Economics, Boston University, Fall 2022
Mathematics for Economists (Graduate), São Paulo School of Economics, Brazil, 2020
Interpretations of Brazil, São Paulo School of Economics, Brazil, 2020
Projects I, São Paulo School of Economics, Brazil, 2019

WORK EXPERIENCE

ACADEMIC

Research Assistant for Krishna Dasaratha, Boston University, 2026
Research Assistant for Chiara Margaria, Boston University, 2025
Research Assistant for Krishna Dasaratha, Boston University, 2024
Research Assistant for Juan Ortner, Boston University, 2023-2024

Research Assistant for Guilherme Lichand, University of Zurich, 2019-2020

INDUSTRY

Cartes Consulting & Training, São Paulo, Brazil, 2015-2019
Founder, Instructor & Consultant (Day-to-Day Data Management Advisory and Training)
KPMG, São Paulo, Brazil, 2014
Trainee (Management Consulting)
Vital Work, São Paulo, Brazil, 2013-2014
Marketing Analyst (Corporate Wellness Advisory)

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Referee for the Brazilian Review of Econometrics
Webmaster for ThReD (Theoretical Research in Development Economics)
Co-organizer of Theory Reading Group

PRESENTATIONS

New England Economics PhD Conference, 2026
3B (BU, BC, Brown) Theory Workshop, 2025
Theory Workshop, Boston University, 2024
3B (BU, BC, Brown) Theory Workshop, 2023
Thesis/Dissertation Seminar, FGV, 2020

FELLOWSHIPS AND AWARDS

Research Grant, Institute for Economic Development (BU), 2025
CAPES Scholarship, CAPES, 2020
Merit Scholarship for 6th place at 2019 ANPEC, São Paulo School of Economics, 2020
CAPES Scholarship, CAPES, 2019
Merit Scholarship for 6th place at 2019 ANPEC, São Paulo School of Economics, 2019
Best Product Design Award (2nd place), Procter & Gamble, 2012

LANGUAGES: English (Fluent), Portuguese (Native), Spanish (Fluent), French (Intermediate)

PROGRAMMING: STATA, R, Python, MATLAB, LaTeX, Mathematica, VBA

CITIZENSHIP/VISA STATUS: Brazil, Portugal, Green Card (USA)

WORK AUTHORIZATION: U.S. Permanent Resident

REFERENCES

Professor Jawwad Noor
Department of Economics
Boston University
Phone: (617) 353-4436
Email: jnoor@bu.edu

Professor Juan Ortner
Department of Economics
Boston University
Phone: (617) 358-4352
Email: jortner@bu.edu

Professor Krishna Dasaratha
Department of Economics
Boston University
Phone: (703) 589-8568
Email: krishnadasaratha@gmail.com

Strategic Obfuscation: Influence Through Information Costs (Job Market Paper)
(with Daniel Monte)

We develop a model of strategic obfuscation in which an interested Principal chooses the cost for a rationally inattentive Decision Maker to process information, making learning costs endogenous. We characterize when the Principal chooses transparency, total obfuscation (no-learning), or partial learning. Endogenous information costs can lead to a counterintuitive implication: increasing the Decision Maker's cost of mistakes can improve her resulting welfare as it leads the Principal to favor more transparency. The framework links persuasion and rational inattention, shifting attention from commitment in disclosure to the design of information costs. The model rationalizes fine print, product complexity, and has implications for disclosure and transparency policy.

Uncertain Prices and Competition: Who Absorbs the Risk?

I study the effects of uncertain prices on competition by risk-neutral firms producing the same homogeneous good. Prices may be uncertain due to exogenous shocks (such as tariffs on imported inputs) that are not yet observed at the time of purchase. Consumers are risk-averse and know they do not observe the real price, so they must make consumption decisions based on a price distribution. Firms choose whether to absorb the shock and offer a fixed price or allow the price to vary according to the shock realization. I find that competition pushes towards uncertainty. While a monopolist would choose to absorb all the price risk, two firms competing à la Bertrand prefer uncertain prices as the risk-averse consumer hedges by buying from both firms. This allows the competing firms to price above marginal cost.

An Axiomatic Approach to Conformity

I provide a behavioral characterization of conformity when individuals have social concerns, as modeled in Bernheim (1994). The problem bridges decision and game theory in a novel way, as the agents' utility function explicitly incorporates an object that is endogenously determined in equilibrium: when agents care about how others perceive them, the equilibrium choice of one type affects the inference function that guides how all other types are judged and, consequently, their payoffs. I first establish a representation theorem using standard decision-theoretic tools, treating the inference function as exogenous. To endogenize the inference function, I describe the necessary restrictions on the utility function to ensure that there exists an action profile that is consistent with both utility maximization and the corresponding inference function.